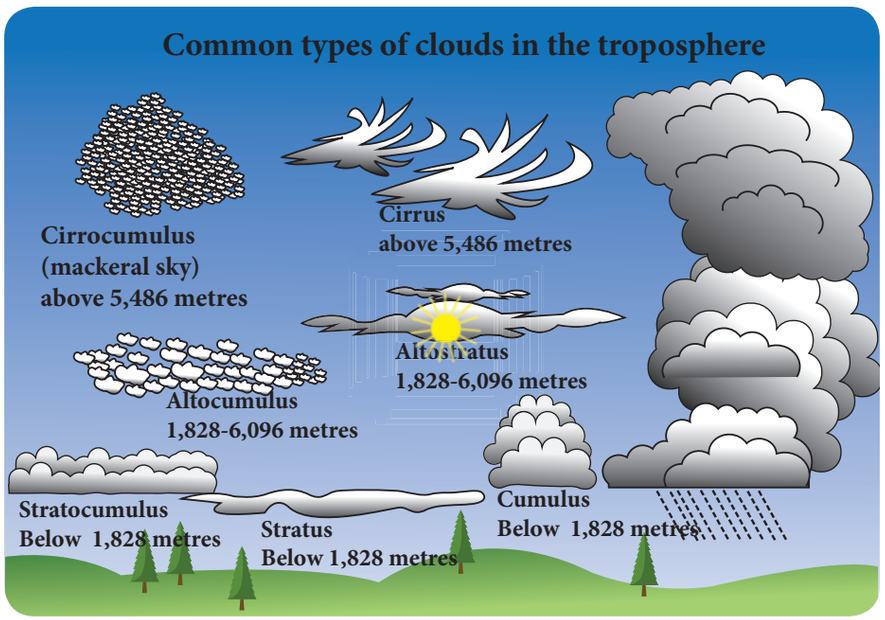


Figure 6.21 Types of Clouds

viii. Nimbostratus (Ni-St): This is dark dull cloud, clearly layered, as it brings rain, snow and sleet and it is called as rainy cloud.

6.5.3 Fog, Mist and Smog

- **'Fog'** is defined as almost microscopic droplets of water condensed from super saturated air and suspended over or near the surface of the earth. Fogs reduce the visibility to less than 1 km. Fog occurs during calm or light wind conditions. It is more common in the areas near to the ocean due to the supply of more moisture by sea breeze. In the interior of the continents fog is formed due to reduction of temperature to extreme low during the winter nights.
- If the fog has higher visibility due to lesser water drops near the surface it is termed as **'mist'.**
- In large industrial areas the air is more polluted. If the fog forms in that area it mixes with the pollutants and turns into smog (smoke + fog = smog) which is more hazardous to the health of the people.(Figure 6.22).



Figure 6.22 Smog at New Delhi

Student Activity

Collect the information regarding the smog in the cities of London (Great London Smog), Bhopal, Beijing and New Delhi.

Identify the precautionary steps to be followed in the regions of smog.

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